Verde River fish: a community linked by total biomass

Simon Frost

Table of contents

The model 1
Projection through the 1964-2017 flow record 2
Agreement with the original R code 3
What the pool does 3
Asking a new question takes one line 5
Reference 6

```
ENV["GKSwstype"] = "100"
using MatrixCommunityModels
using MatrixProjectionModels: lambda
using Plots, Printf
```

The model

Rogosch et al. (2019) modelled seven fish species of the Verde River, Arizona: three natives (*Catostomus clarkii* CACL, *Gila robusta* GIRO, *Catostomus insignis* CAIN) and four non-natives (*Lepomis cyanellus* LECY, *Micropterus dolomieu* MIDO, *Cyprinella lutrensis* CYLU, *Ameiurus natalis* AMNA). Each species has three stages and its state is biomass in grams. Survival depends on the kind of year (spring flood, summer flood, medium flood, drought, or none of these). The species are linked by one dependency assumption: the fecundity of every species is multiplied by `max(0, 1 - B/K)`, where `B` is the total biomass of all fish and $K = 47{,}660$ g.

`verde_fish_model()` builds this community from the published vital-rate tables. Its source in `src/models.jl` is short: three survival transitions and one to three fecundity transitions per species, and one line saying that every stage occupies the `biomass` pool gram for gram.

```
m = verde_fish_model()
fish = m.community
```

```
OpenCommunity(CACL, GIRO, LECY, CAIN, MIDO, CYLU, AMNA; pools = biomass)
```

```
[(t.name, t.from => t.to, t.kind) for t in species(fish, :CYLU).transitions]
```

```
6-element Vector{Tuple{Symbol, Pair{Symbol, Symbol}, Symbol}}:
 (:growth1, :s1 => :s2, :survival)
 (:growth2, :s2 => :s3, :survival)
 (:stasis3, :s3 => :s3, :survival)
 (:eggs_s1, :s1 => :s1, :fecundity)
 (:eggs_s2, :s2 => :s1, :fecundity)
 (:eggs_s3, :s3 => :s1, :fecundity)
```

Projection through the 1964-2017 flow record

Each year's environment is its set of year-type flags.

```
m.years[1:3], m.envs[1:3]
```

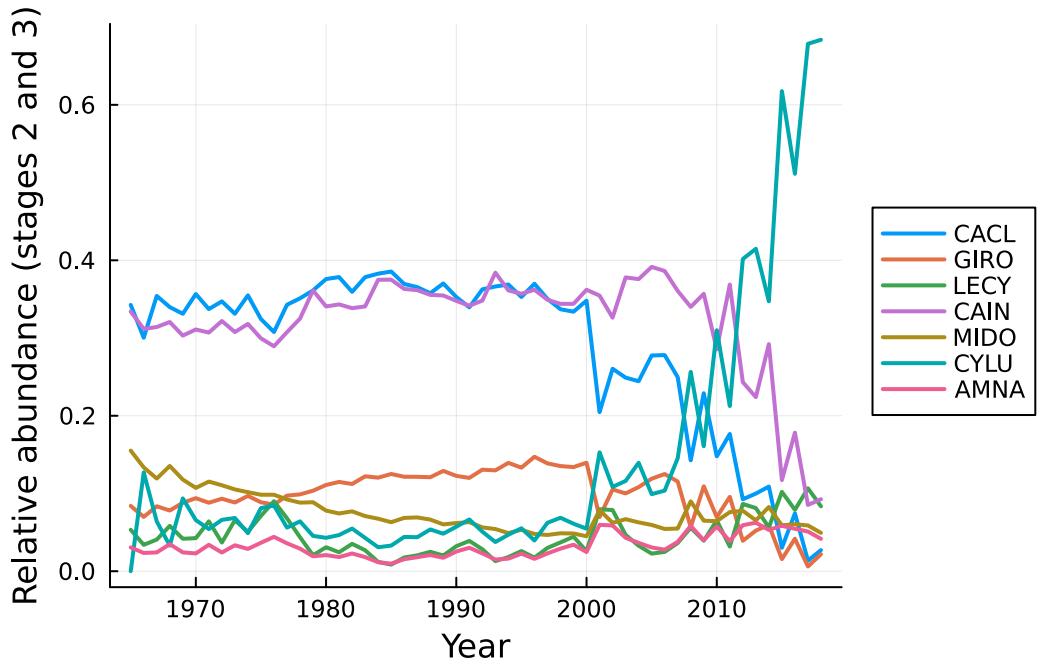
```
([1964, 1965, 1966], [(SP_highflood = 0, SU_highflood = 1, medflood = 0,
 ↪  drought = 0, nonevent = 0), (SP_highflood = 0, SU_highflood = 0,
 ↪  medflood = 1, drought = 0, nonevent = 0), (SP_highflood = 1,
 ↪  SU_highflood = 0, medflood = 0, drought = 0, nonevent = 0)])
```

```
sol = project(fish, m.n0, m.envs)
```

```
CommunityTrajectory(54 steps, 21 states)
```

Rogosch et al. report relative abundance of the two older stages. Biomass converts to numbers through the individuals-per-gram of each stage.

```
adults = reduce(hcat, [sol[sp][:, 2] .* m.density[sp][2] .+ sol[sp][:, 3]
 ↪  .* m.density[sp][3]
                       for sp in species_names(fish)])
rel = adults ./ sum(adults; dims = 2)
yrs = [m.years; m.years[end] + 1]
plot(yrs[2:end], rel[2:end, :]; label =
 ↪  permutedims(String.(species_names(fish))),
     xlabel = "Year", ylabel = "Relative abundance (stages 2 and 3)", lw =
 ↪  2, legend = :outerright)
```



Agreement with the original R code

`test/reference/fish_det_biomass.csv` was produced by the authors' R script, run with the same flow record and the initial biomass of the vital-rate table (see `test/reference/R/run_fish_reference.R`). Each of its rows is the state before that year's update.

```
ref_file = joinpath(pkgdir(MatrixCommunityModels), "test", "reference",
 ↪  "fish_det_biomass.csv")
ref = permutedims(reduce(hcat, [parse.(Float64, split(l, ",")[2:end]) for l
 ↪  in readlines(ref_file)[2:end]]))
got = sol.u[1:54, :]
(identical = count(got .== ref), of = length(ref), max_abs_difference =
 ↪  maximum(abs.(got .- ref)))
```

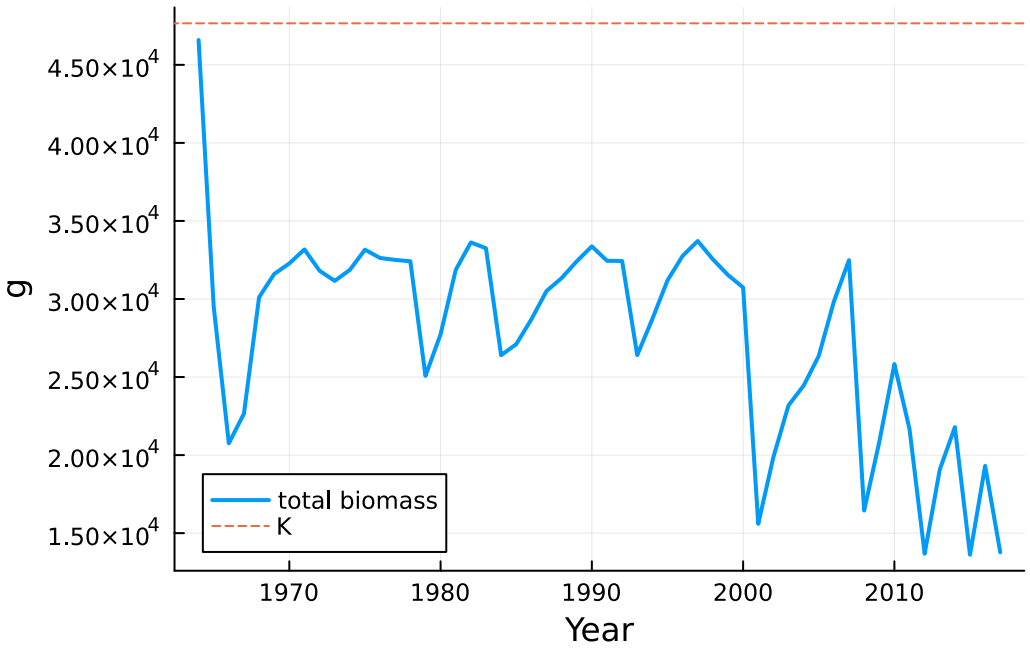
```
(identical = 1134, of = 1134, max_abs_difference = 0.0)
```

All 1134 values (54 years, 21 states) are identical to the last bit.

What the pool does

Total biomass, the only thing the species share, stays below `K`:

```
plot(m.years, sol.pools[1:end-1, 1]; label = "total biomass", xlabel =
 ↪  "Year", ylabel = "g", lw = 2)
hline!([47660]; label = "K", ls = :dash)
```



Freezing a species at a year type and a biomass gives an ordinary projection matrix, so its growth rate in that situation can be read off. Here each species alone in an almost empty river, by year type:

```
flags(; kw...) = merge((SP_highflood = 0, SU_highflood = 0, medflood = 0,
 ↪  drought = 0, nonevent = 0), kw)
types = ["spring flood" => flags(SP_highflood = 1), "summer flood" =>
 ↪  flags(SU_highflood = 1),
         "medium flood" => flags(medflood = 1), "drought" => flags(drought =
          ↪  1),
         "non-event" => flags(nonevent = 1)]
for sp in species(fish)
    lams = [lambda(lower(sp, Context(zeros(3), (biomass = 0.0,), env))) for
 ↪  (_, env) in types]
    @printf("%-5s %s\n", sp.name, join([@sprintf("%-13s %5.2f", first(t), l)
     ↪  for (t, l) in zip(types, lams)], "  "))
end
```

```
CACL  spring flood   1.42  summer flood   1.30  medium flood   1.41  drought
 ↪  0.59  non-event      1.30
GIRO  spring flood   1.53  summer flood   1.37  medium flood   1.51  drought
 ↪  0.67  non-event      1.37
```

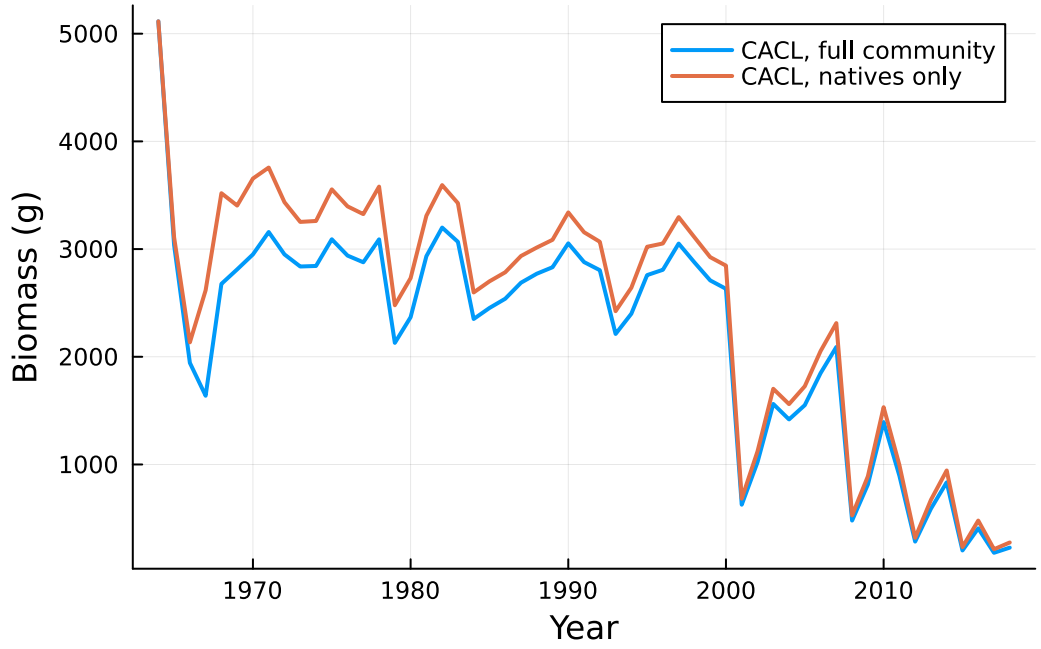
```
LECY  spring flood   1.31  summer flood   0.84  medium flood   1.31  drought
 ↪  1.55  non-event      1.82
CAIN  spring flood   1.34  summer flood   1.27  medium flood   1.34  drought
 ↪  0.81  non-event      1.27
MIDO  spring flood   1.25  summer flood   1.17  medium flood   1.25  drought
 ↪  1.23  non-event      1.31
CYLU  spring flood   1.47  summer flood   1.25  medium flood   1.47  drought
 ↪  1.78  non-event      1.74
AMNA  spring flood   1.20  summer flood   0.98  medium flood   1.20  drought
 ↪  1.33  non-event      1.62
```

The natives (CACL, GIRO, CAIN) do best after spring floods and decline in droughts; the non-natives do best in droughts and non-event years. That is the autecology the model was given. Competition appears only when the community is put together.

Asking a new question takes one line

Because the community is a composite, changing its membership is a matter of composing a different set of species. The natives without the non-natives:

```
natives = community((species(fish, s) for s in (:CACL, :GIRO, :CAIN))...)
n0 = [p for p in m.n0 if p.first in (:CACL, :GIRO, :CAIN)]
alone = project(natives, n0, m.envs)
plot(yrs, [sum(sol[:CACL]; dims = 2) sum(alone[:CACL]; dims = 2)];
     label = ["CACL, full community" "CACL, natives only"], xlabel = "Year",
 ↪  ylabel = "Biomass (g)", lw = 2)
```



Reference

Rogosch, J. S., Tonkin, J. D., Lytle, D. A., Merritt, D. M., Reynolds, L. V. & Olden, J. D. (2019). Increasing drought favors nonnative fishes in a dryland river: evidence from a multispecies demographic model. *Ecosphere* 10, e02681. Code and data: https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.1309024 (MIT licence).